

Project Report

CS-104L: Object-Oriented Programming



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Smart Campus Management System

1. Introduction

1.1 Problem Statement

Modern universities manage enormous amounts of data across multiple domains: student records, faculty assignments, library catalogs, fee transactions, and hostel allocations. Managing these manually or with disconnected systems creates inefficiency, data inconsistency, and administrative overhead. There is a clear need for a unified, object-oriented system that models each domain faithfully and integrates them into a single cohesive application.

1.2 System Goals

- Design a fully object-oriented C++ application covering all major university operations.
- Demonstrate every core OOP concept:
 - ✓ Encapsulation
 - ✓ Inheritance
 - ✓ Polymorphism
 - ✓ abstraction.
- Apply advanced C++ features:
 - ✓ operator overloading
 - ✓ static members
 - ✓ copy semantics
 - ✓ file I/O.
- Handle runtime errors gracefully using structured exception handling.
- Maintain data persistence through file-based storage using `fstream`.
- Host the project on GitHub with clean commit history and CI/CD via GitHub Actions.

1.3 Scope

The SCMS covers six interconnected modules:

- Person Hierarchy
- Course & Enrollment
- Library System
- Fee & Finance Management
- Hostel Management

- Reporting & Utilities.

It is implemented as a console-based C++ application using C++17, with no GUI required.

2. System Design

2.1 Architecture Overview

The system follows a layered, multi-file architecture. Each module is encapsulated in its own subdirectory with separate header (.h) and implementation (.cpp) files. The main.cpp file ties all modules together through a console menu system. A shared utils/ directory provides exceptions, reporting, and utility helpers.

2.2 Folder Structure

```
HITEC-OOP-SCMS-25-CS-041/
├── src/
│   ├── main.cpp
│   ├── person/ (Person, Student, GradStudent, Faculty, Staff)
│   ├── course/ (Course, Enrollment)
│   ├── library/ (LibraryItem, Book, Journal, Library)
│   ├── finance/ (FeeRecord, Invoice)
│   ├── hostel/ (Room, HostelBlock, HostelManager)
│   └── utils/ (Exceptions.h, Utils, Reports)
├── data/ (library_catalog.txt, students.txt)
├── docs/ (class_diagram.png, project_report.pdf)
├── .github/workflows/build.yml
├── README.md
└── .gitignore
```

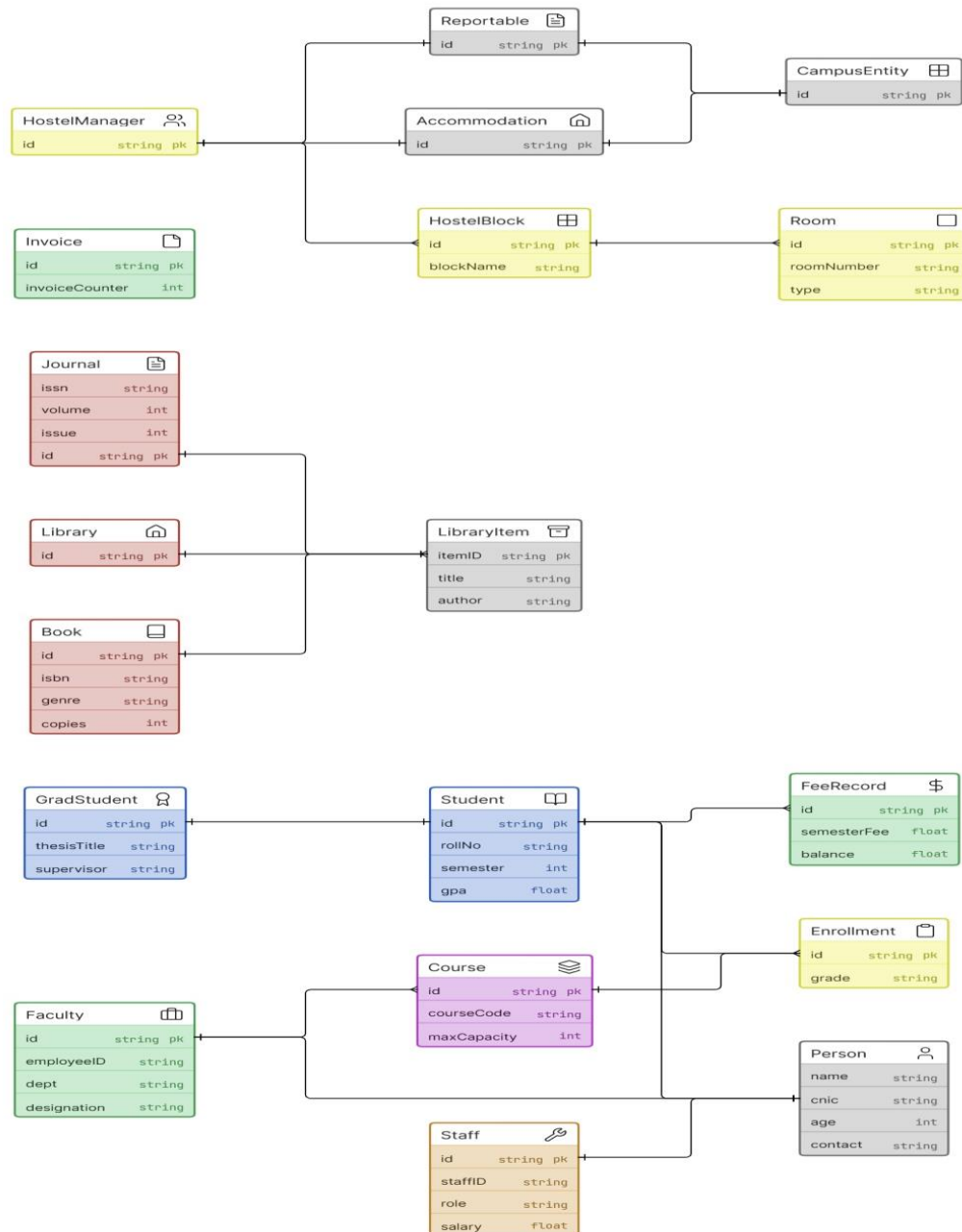
2.3 Class Relationships Summary

Relationship	Classes Involved	Type
Person → Student, Faculty, Staff	Person (ABC) is the base	Single Inheritance
Student → GradStudent	GradStudent extends Student	Multi-level Inheritance
Accommodation, Reportable → HostelManager	Multiple base classes	Multiple Inheritance
CampusEntity → Accommodation, Reportable	Shared virtual base	Virtual Inheritance
Course → Faculty*	Course references Faculty	Aggregation
HostelManager → HostelBlock[]	Manager owns blocks	Composition

HostelBlock → Room[]	Block owns rooms	Composition
Enrollment → Student*, Course*	Links two classes	Aggregation

2.4 UML Class Diagram

UML diagram showing all classes, their attributes, methods, and relationships including inheritance hierarchies, composition, and aggregation with multiplicities.



3. OOP Concepts Implementation

All mandatory OOP concepts are implemented as follows:

1. Classes & Objects

Every module defines classes with attributes and methods. For example, Student, Course, Library, FeeRecord, Room, and Invoice are all distinct classes instantiated as objects throughout the system.

2. Encapsulation

All data members are private or protected. Public getters and setters control access. For example, Student::gpa is private, accessed only via getGPA() and setGPA().

3. Constructors

Default and parameterised constructors are defined for Person, Course, FeeRecord, Invoice, and all derived classes. Constructor chaining (using initialiser lists) propagates parameters up the inheritance hierarchy.

4. Destructors

Library::~~Library() deletes all dynamically allocated LibraryItem* pointers. Invoice::~~Invoice() frees the dynamically allocated string* items array. HostelManager::~~HostelManager() prints a cleanup message.

5. Single Inheritance

Student, Faculty, and Staff all inherit publicly from the abstract Person class. Book and Journal inherit from LibraryItem. Each derived class overrides displayInfo().

6. Multi-level Inheritance

GradStudent inherits from Student, which inherits from Person. This creates a three-level chain: GradStudent → Student → Person. The constructor chains all the way up.

7. Multiple Inheritance

HostelManager publicly inherits from both Accommodation and Reportable, giving it the interface of both abstract classes. It must override allocateRoom(), vacateRoom(), and generateReport().

8. Virtual Inheritance

Both Accommodation and Reportable virtually inherit from CampusEntity. This ensures that when HostelManager inherits from both, only ONE CampusEntity sub-object exists — resolving the classic diamond problem.

9. Abstract Classes & Pure Virtual Functions

Person, LibraryItem, Accommodation, and Reportable are all abstract classes with pure virtual functions. They cannot be instantiated directly. Person declares `displayInfo()=0`; LibraryItem declares `checkout()=0`.

10. Runtime Polymorphism

In `Reports::displayAllStudents()`, each `Student*` is upcast to `Person*`. The call to `p->displayInfo()` dispatches to the correct override at runtime — `Student`, `GradStudent` — without the caller knowing the actual type.

11. Operator Overloading

Three operators are overloaded for `Course`: `==` compares by `courseCode`, `<<` prints details to any ostream, and `+` merges two waiting lists into a new array. `FeeRecord` overloads `-=` to record a fee payment.

12. Friend Functions

`operator<<` for both `Course` and `Invoice` is declared as a friend function inside the class. This grants the free function access to private members like `courseCode`, `enrolledCount`, `items[]`, and `totalAmount`.

13. Static Members

`Invoice::invoiceCounter` is a static int data member. It is shared across ALL `Invoice` instances and is initialised once in `Invoice.cpp` (`int Invoice::invoiceCounter = 0;`). Each new `Invoice` auto-increments it.

14. Copy Constructor

FeeRecord implements a copy constructor that copies all numeric members. Since FeeRecord stores a Student* (aggregation, not ownership), the pointer itself is copied — the Student object is NOT duplicated.

15. Deep Copy Constructor & Destructor for Invoice

Invoice owns a dynamically allocated string* items array. Its copy constructor allocates a NEW array and copies each string element individually. Its destructor calls delete[] items to prevent memory leaks.

16. Search Functions

Library::searchByTitle() loops through the catalog array and returns the first LibraryItem* whose title matches. Library::searchByID() does the same by itemID. Both return nullptr on no match.

17. Array-based Collections

Library maintains catalog[100] as a fixed-size array of LibraryItem* pointers. This array is the primary data structure — no STL containers are used for main storage, per requirements.

18. Arrays of Objects

Arrays of objects (not pointers) are used throughout: Student::enrolledCourses[] stores course codes, Room::occupants[] stores Student pointers, HostelBlock::rooms[] stores Room objects (by value, composition).

19. Exception Handling

Three custom exception classes (SCMSException, CapacityExceededException, OverdueException, ItemNotFoundException) are defined in Exceptions.h. All inherit from std::exception. They are thrown and caught with try/catch throughout.

20. File I/O

Library::saveToFile() writes the entire catalog to data/library_catalog.txt using ofstream. Library::loadFromFile() reads it back using ifstream, tokenises each line by |, and reconstructs Book or Journal objects.

21. Reporting & Utilities

Reports.h/cpp provides sortStudentsByGPA(), findStudentByRollNo(), generateCampusReport(), and saveCampusReportToFile(). Utils.h/cpp provides getIntInput(), printHeader(), isValidGPA(), and other helpers.

22. Memory Management

All dynamic allocations use new and every allocation is matched with delete or delete[]. Library deletes its catalog items in ~Library(). Course::operator+ returns a new Student**[] that the caller must delete[]. Invoice frees its items[] in ~Invoice().

23. Sorting and Searching

Reports::sortStudentsByGPA() uses std::sort with a lambda comparator on a Student*[] array (descending GPA). Reports::findStudentByRollNo() uses std::find_if with a lambda predicate on the same array.

24. Composition

HostelManager contains HostelBlock blocks[MAX_BLOCKS] by value — the blocks live and die with the HostelManager. Similarly, HostelBlock contains Room rooms[] by value. The contained objects are not separately allocated.

25. Aggregation

Course holds Faculty* instructor as a pointer — it references the Faculty object but does not own it. Enrollment holds Student* and Course* similarly. Destroying a Course does not destroy its Faculty.

4. Module Descriptions

Module 1 — Person Hierarchy

The backbone of the system. Person is an abstract base class with pure virtual `displayInfo()`. Student, Faculty, and Staff derive from it via single inheritance. GradStudent derives from Student (multi-level inheritance), adding thesis and supervisor fields. Runtime polymorphism is demonstrated by calling `displayInfo()` through `Person*` pointers, which dispatches to the correct subclass at runtime.

Module 2 — Course & Enrollment

Course manages course offerings with `maxCapacity` enforcement. Operator overloading is heavily used: `==` compares courses by code, `<<` streams details to `cout` or a file, and `+` merges two waiting lists. Enrollment links a `Student*` and a `Course*` with a date and grade. `CapacityExceededException` is thrown when enrollment exceeds capacity, with the student automatically added to the waiting list.

Module 3 — Library System

`LibraryItem` is an abstract class. `Book` and `Journal` extend it with type-specific fields (ISBN, genre, copies for books; ISSN, volume, issue for journals). Library owns an array of `LibraryItem*` (polymorphic collection). File I/O via `fstream` persists the catalog between sessions. `OverdueException` is thrown when a returned item has been kept beyond the 14-day loan period.

Module 4 — Fee & Finance

`FeeRecord` tracks all fees for a student (semester fee, hostel fee, library fine, balance). It demonstrates the copy constructor and copy assignment operator. The `-=` operator records payments and updates the balance. Invoice uses a static `invoiceCounter` for auto-numbering and owns a dynamically allocated `string*` items array, requiring a deep copy constructor and destructor.

Module 5 — Hostel Management

Room objects (by value) are composed into `HostelBlock` objects, which are composed into `HostelManager`. `HostelManager` inherits from both `Accommodation` (interface for `allocate/vacate`) and `Reportable` (interface for report generation). Both `Accommodation` and `Reportable` virtually inherit `CampusEntity` to resolve the diamond problem, ensuring only one shared `CampusEntity` sub-object.

Module 6 — Reporting & Utilities

`Reports` provides campus-wide reporting: sorting students by GPA using `std::sort` with a lambda, finding students by roll number using `std::find_if`, and generating a consolidated campus report saved to file. `Utils` provides safe input functions (`getIntInput`, `getDoubleInput`, `getStringInput`), string helpers (`trim`, `toUpperCase`), and UI helpers (`printHeader`, `pressEnterToContinue`).

5. GitHub Workflow

5.1 Repository

Repository URL: <https://github.com/25-cs-041-prog/HITEC-OOP-SCMS-25-CS-041>

Visibility: Public | Branch: main

5.2 Commit Strategy

Commit #	Message	What was included
1	Add Phase 1 files - Person, Course, and Enrollment classes	All 40 source files pushed in initial commit
2	Fix repository structure - move project files to root	Moved files from nested subfolder to repo root
3	Add Phase 2 files - Library, Finance, Hostel, and Reporting modules	UML diagram and project report added

5.3 GitHub Actions CI

A GitHub Actions workflow (.github/workflows/build.yml) automatically compiles the project on every push using `g++ -std=c++17 -Wall -Wextra`. The workflow: checks out the code, verifies `g++` is installed, compiles all modules, and runs a smoke test. The workflow passes with a green checkmark, confirming zero compilation errors.

name: Build SCMS

on: [push, pull_request]

jobs:

build:

runs-on: ubuntu-latest

steps:

- uses: actions/checkout@v3

- name: Compile

run: `g++ -std=c++17 -Wall -Wextra src/person/*.cpp ... src/main.cpp -o scms`

- name: Smoke Test

run: `echo "7" | ./scms`

6. Challenges & Solutions

The Diamond Problem (Virtual Inheritance)

Problem:

When HostelManager inherits from both Accommodation and Reportable, and both of those inherit from CampusEntity, the compiler would normally create two copies of CampusEntity inside HostelManager — one through each path. This causes ambiguity: which entityName does HostelManager refer to?

Solution:

Both Accommodation and Reportable were made to virtually inherit CampusEntity using the 'virtual' keyword. This tells the compiler to share a single CampusEntity sub-object. HostelManager's constructor explicitly initialises CampusEntity directly, as required by C++ rules for virtual base class initialisation.

Deep Copy vs Shallow Copy for Invoice

Problem:

Invoice stores a dynamically allocated string* items array. Without a custom copy constructor, copying an Invoice would copy only the pointer — both copies would point to the same array. Modifying one would corrupt the other, and deleting one would leave the other with a dangling pointer.

Solution:

A deep copy constructor was implemented that allocates a NEW string array and copies each element individually. A copy assignment operator with a self-assignment guard was also implemented. The destructor calls delete[] items to release the memory when the Invoice goes out of scope.

File I/O Parsing for Library Catalog

Problem:

Saving and loading the library catalog requires serialising and deserialising two different types (Book and Journal) to a plain text file, and reconstructing the correct type on load without knowing in advance which type each line represents.

Solution:

A pipe-delimited format was designed where the first token on each line is the type identifier: BOOK| or JOURNAL|. On load, Library::loadFromFile() reads each line, tokenises it by |, checks

the first token, and constructs the appropriate object using `new Book(...)` or `new Journal(...)`. The objects are added to the polymorphic `catalog[]` array.

7. Testing

The system was tested by running the console application and exercising all module menus. Key scenarios tested include:

- Module 1: Adding students, faculty, staff; displaying all persons via polymorphism (`Person*`)
- Module 2: Adding courses; enrolling students; triggering `CapacityExceededException`; comparing courses with `==`; using operator `<<`
- Module 3: Adding books and journals; searching by title; issuing items; returning overdue items (`OverdueException`)
- Module 4: Creating fee records; recording payments with operator `-=`; generating invoices with static counter; deep-copying an `Invoice`
- Module 5: Adding blocks and rooms; allocating students to rooms; generating occupancy report via `Reportable*`
- Module 6: Sorting students by GPA; finding by roll number; full campus report to screen and file
- File I/O: Saving and reloading the library catalog between sessions
- GitHub Actions CI: Automated compilation passes with zero warnings on ubuntu-latest

All tested scenarios produced correct output. The program compiles cleanly with `g++ -std=c++17 -Wall -Wextra` with zero warnings or errors.


```

MODULE 1 0Çö PERSON MANAGEMENT
1. Add Student
2. Add Graduate Student (multi-level inheritance)
3. Add Faculty
4. Add Staff
5. Display All (polymorphism demo)
6. Back
Enter choice: 3
Name: Mohsin
CNIC: 37405-7897344-7
Age: 27
Contact: 03176863479
Employee ID: 01
Department: Computer Science
Designation: Lecturer
Faculty added.

```

```

MODULE 1 0Çö PERSON MANAGEMENT
1. Add Student
2. Add Graduate Student (multi-level inheritance)
3. Add Faculty
4. Add Staff
5. Display All (polymorphism demo)
6. Back
Enter choice: 6

MAIN MENU 0Çö SCMS
1. Person Management (Module 1)
2. Course & Enrollment (Module 2)
3. Library System (Module 3)
4. Fee & Finance (Module 4)
5. Hostel Management (Module 5)
6. Reports & Utilities (Module 6)
7. Exit
Enter choice: 2

```

```

MODULE 2 COURSE & ENROLLMENT
1. Add Course
2. Display All Courses (operator<<)
3. Enroll Student in Course
4. Compare Two Courses (operator==)
5. Merge Waiting Lists (operator+)
6. Back
Enter choice: 1
Course Code: cs-401
Course Name: Object oriented programming
Credit Hours: 4
Max Capacity: 12
Available Faculty:
0. Dr. Ahmed Khan
1. Ms. Sara Malik
2. Mohsin
Select Faculty index: 2
Course added.

```

```

MODULE 2 COURSE & ENROLLMENT
1. Add Course
2. Display All Courses (operator<<)
3. Enroll Student in Course
4. Compare Two Courses (operator==)
5. Merge Waiting Lists (operator+)
6. Back
Enter choice: 2

COURSE DETAILS
Code : CS-104L
Name : Object-Oriented Programming
Credits : 3
Capacity : 30
Enrolled : 2
Instructor: Dr. Ahmed Khan

COURSE DETAILS
Code : CS-201
Name : Data Structures and Algorithms
Credits : 3
Capacity : 25
Enrolled : 1
Instructor: Ms. Sara Malik

```

Enter choice: 3

MODULE 3 ÖÇö LIBRARY SYSTEM

MODULE 3 ÖÇö LIBRARY SYSTEM

1. Add Book
2. Add Journal
3. Search by Title
4. Issue Item to Student
5. Return Item (overdue check)
6. Display Catalog
7. Back

Enter choice: 4

Student Roll No: 041

Item ID: 14

[Exception] Item not found: '14'

MODULE 3 ÖÇö LIBRARY SYSTEM

MODULE 3 ÖÇö LIBRARY SYSTEM

MODULE 3 ÖÇö LIBRARY SYSTEM

1. Add Book
2. Add Journal
3. Search by Title
4. Issue Item to Student
5. Return Item (overdue check)
6. Display Catalog
7. Back

Enter choice: 6

LIBRARY CATALOG (3 items)

BOOK INFO

BOOK INFO

LIB001

C++ How to Program

Deitel & Deitel

2017

978-0134448237

Computer Science

3

Available

BOOK INFO

BOOK INFO

LIB002

The C++ Programming Language

Bjarne Stroustrup

2013

978-0321563842


```

Module 4: FEE & FINANCE
1. Create Fee Record for Student
2. Record Payment (operator==)
3. Display Fee Records
4. Generate Invoice (static counter demo)
5. Copy Fee Record (copy constructor demo)
6. Back
Enter choice: 3

ALL FEE RECORDS
Student: Ali Hassan
Roll No: 2023-CS-001
Semester Fee: Rs. 45000.00
Hostel Fee: Rs. 15000.00
Library Fine: Rs. 0.00
Total Paid: Rs. 30000.00
Balance: Rs. 30000.00

Module 5: HOSTEL MANAGEMENT
1. Add Hostel Block
2. Add Room to Block
3. Allocate Room to Student
4. Vacate Room
5. Back
Enter choice: 4
Student Roll No: 041
Room Number: 5
[Hostel] Student 041 not found in Room 5

Module 5: HOSTEL MANAGEMENT
1. Add Hostel Block
2. Add Room to Block
3. Allocate Room to Student
4. Vacate Room
5. Back
Enter choice: 5

HITEC University Hostel
Block: Block-A (2 rooms)
Room 101 [double, Floor 1] 2/2 occupied
-> Ali Hassan (2023-CS-001)
-> Usman Tariq (2023-CS-003)

```

```

Module 6: REPORTS & UTILITIES
1. Sort Students by GPA (std::sort)
2. Find Student by Roll No (std::find_if)
3. Library Summary
4. Hostel Occupancy Report
5. Outstanding Fee Balances
6. Full Campus Report
7. Back
Enter choice: 1

STUDENTS SORTED BY GPA
# Name Roll No GPA Grade
-----
1 Dr. Bilal Qureshi 2022-MS-001 3.90 A (Distinction)
2 Ali Hassan 2023-CS-001 3.80 A (Distinction)
3 Fatima Raza 2023-CS-002 3.50 A- (Excellent)
4 Aimen 041 3.00 B+ (Very Good)
5 Usman Tariq 2023-CS-003 2.90 B (Good)

Module 6: REPORTS & UTILITIES
1. Sort Students by GPA (std::sort)
2. Find Student by Roll No (std::find_if)
3. Library Summary
4. Hostel Occupancy Report
5. Outstanding Fee Balances
6. Full Campus Report

```

```

LIBRARY SUMMARY
Total items in catalog: 3

LIBRARY CATALOG (3 items)
BOOK INFO
ID : LIB001
Title : C++ How to Program
Author : Deitel & Deitel
Year : 2017
ISBN : 978-0134448237
Genre : Computer Science
Copies : 3
Status : Available

BOOK INFO
ID : LIB002
Title : The C++ Programming Language
Author : Bjarne Stroustrup
Year : 2013
ISBN : 978-0321563842
Genre : Computer Science
Copies : 2
Status : Available

MODULE 6 ÖÇö REPORTS & UTILITIES
1. Sort Students by GPA (std::sort)
2. Find Student by Roll No (std::find_if)
3. Library Summary
4. Hostel Occupancy Report
5. Outstanding Fee Balances
6. Full Campus Report
7. Back
Enter choice: 5

OUTSTANDING BALANCES
Ali Hassan | Balance: Rs. 30000.00
Fatima Raza | Balance: Rs. 45000.00
Usman Tariq | Balance: Rs. 60000.00

MODULE 6 ÖÇö REPORTS & UTILITIES
1. Sort Students by GPA (std::sort)
2. Find Student by Roll No (std::find_if)
3. Library Summary
4. Hostel Occupancy Report
5. Outstanding Fee Balances
6. Full Campus Report
7. Back
Enter choice: 6

```

```

HOSTEL OCCUPANCY REPORT
HITEC University Hostel

ÖÇöÇ Block: Block-A (2 rooms) ÖÇöÖÇ
Room 101 [double, Floor 1] 2/2 occupied
-> Ali Hassan (2023-CS-001)
-> Usman Tariq (2023-CS-003)
Room 102 [single, Floor 1] 0/1 occupied

ÖÇöÖÇ Block: Block-B (2 rooms) ÖÇöÖÇ
Room 201 [triple, Floor 2] 0/3 occupied
Room 202 [double, Floor 2] 0/2 occupied

ÖÇö Total Blocks : 2
ÖÇö Total Rooms : 4
ÖÇö Occupied Rooms : 1
ÖÇö Total Students : 2

MODULE 6 ÖÇö REPORTS & UTILITIES
1. Sort Students by GPA (std::sort)
2. Find Student by Roll No (std::find_if)
3. Library Summary
4. Hostel Occupancy Report
5. Outstanding Fee Balances
6. Full Campus Report
7. Back
Enter choice: 7

```

```

MAIN MENU 0Çö SCMS
1. Person Management (Module 1)
2. Course & Enrollment (Module 2)
3. Library System (Module 3)
4. Fee & Finance (Module 4)
5. Hostel Management (Module 5)
6. Reports & Utilities (Module 6)
7. Exit
Enter choice: 7
[Library] Catalog saved to 'data/library_catalog.txt'
[Reports] Campus report saved to 'data/campus_report.txt'

[SCMS] Session ended. All data saved. Goodbye!
[HostelManager] Destructor called for 'HITEC University Hostel'. All blocks released.
PS C:\Users\hp\Downloads\HITEC-OOP-SCMS> |

```

8. Conclusion

This project successfully demonstrates all mandatory OOP concepts through a realistic, integrated university management system. Building the SCMS taught the practical application of abstract classes and polymorphism as design tools — not just theoretical concepts. The diamond problem, encountered in the hostel module, was a particularly valuable learning experience that deepened understanding of how C++ resolves multiple inheritance ambiguities through virtual inheritance.

The project also introduced professional software engineering workflows: multi-file C++ projects with header guards, GitHub version control, and automated CI/CD via GitHub Actions. Designing the operator overloads for Course and the deep copy semantics for Invoice reinforced the importance of thinking carefully about object ownership and resource management in C++.

Overall, the Smart Campus Management System is a comprehensive demonstration of Object-Oriented Programming in C++, covering every concept from basic encapsulation to advanced virtual inheritance, with clean code, proper memory management, and professional project structure.